Enforcing Mandatory Fields Using UI Policies and Migrating Changes with Update Sets

Introduction:
ServiceNow is widely used for managing IT services and workflows. Ensuring accurate and complete data entry is critical for smooth operations. However, users often submit forms with missing or incomplete information, which leads to inefficiencies, processing delays, and poor decision-making.

Problem Statement:
There is a lack of dynamic validation in forms, resulting in inconsistent data entry. Mandatory fields are not enforced based on conditions such as request type or category. Additionally, configuration changes made in development instances are not efficiently migrated to testing and production environments.

Proposed Solution:
UI Policies in ServiceNow can be used to dynamically enforce mandatory fields based on defined conditions. This ensures that users provide all required information before submission. Update Sets are used to track and migrate these configurations across different environments in a structured and reliable manner.

Objectives:
- Enforce condition-based mandatory fields using UI Policies
- Improve data consistency and quality
- Reduce manual validation and errors
- Ensure smooth migration using Update Sets

Expected Outcome:
Implementation of UI Policies will ensure complete data capture, while Update Sets will enable seamless migration of configurations across environments. This results in improved efficiency, reliability, and system performance.

Update Sets

Epic | Complexity: Medium | Duration: 2h 0m

Description

In this phase, a Local Update Set is created to track and manage all configuration changes made during the project. The activity begins by navigating to the Update Sets module in ServiceNow and creating a new Local Update Set with appropriate details such as name and description. Once created, the Update Set is marked as *Current* to ensure that all subsequent configurations—including UI Policies and UI Actions—are automatically captured. This step establishes a controlled change management process and ensures that all project-related updates can be reviewed, migrated, and deployed consistently across different ServiceNow instances.

Resources

No resources available

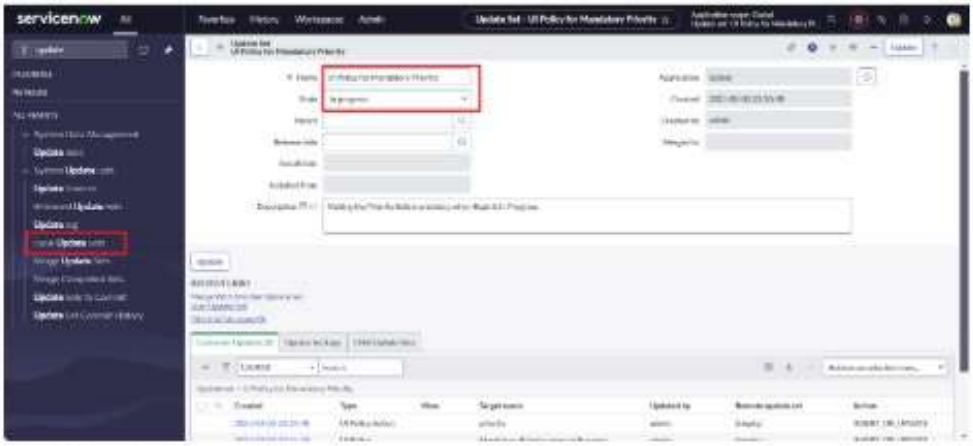
Create Update Set

Story Duration: 2h 0m

In Progress

Description

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Update Sets
3. Select Local Update Sets
4. Click on new
5. Fill the details below and make current.



6. Click submit.

Resources

No resources available

UI policy

Epic | Complexity: Medium | Duration: 1h 59m

Description

In this phase, a UI Policy is configured to control form behaviour on the Incident table based on business conditions. The activity involves navigating to the UI Policies module and creating a new policy with the required conditions to evaluate the incident state. After saving the UI Policy, a UI Policy Action is added to dynamically enforce the **Priority** field behaviour on the form. By setting the Priority field as mandatory through the UI Policy Action, the system ensures users provide critical information when updating incidents, improving data consistency and compliance while avoiding the need for custom scripting.

Resources

No resources available

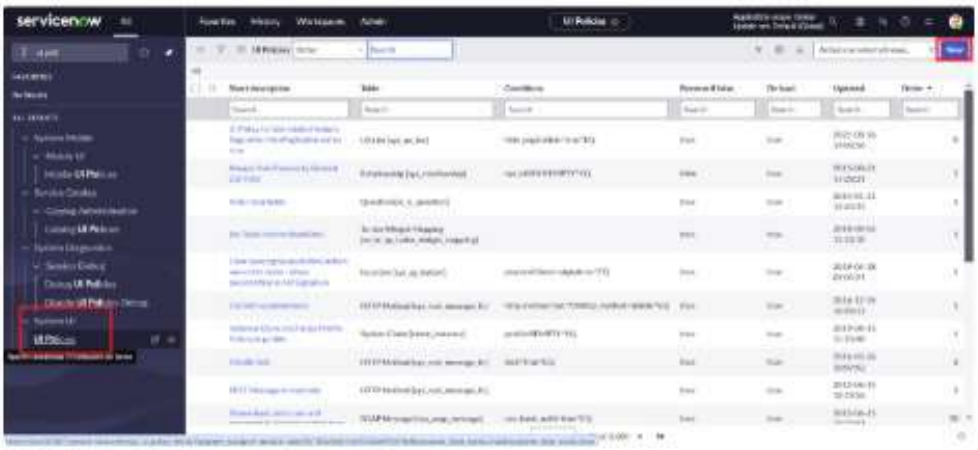
Create UI policy

Story Duration: 40m

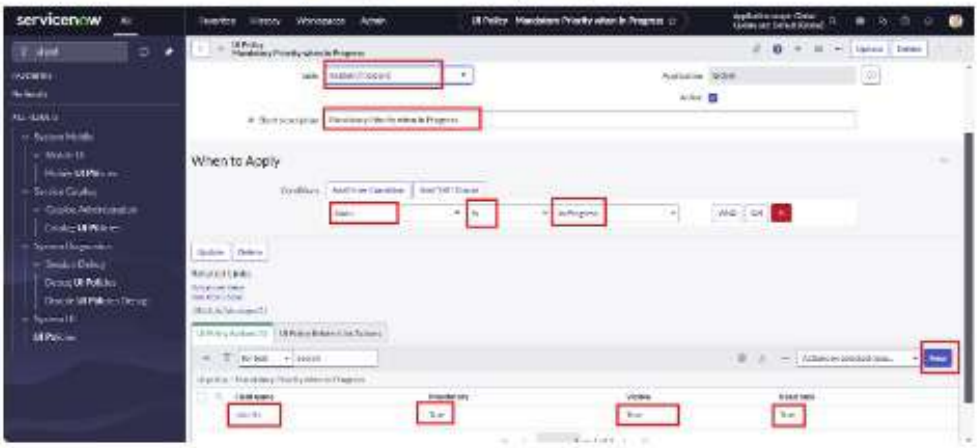
In Progress

Description

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for ui policies
3. Navigate to System UI >> UI Policies
4. Click on new



5. Fill the following details and Save
6. Scroll Down and add 'priority' Field on Ui policy Actions



7. Click on submit.

Check Update Set

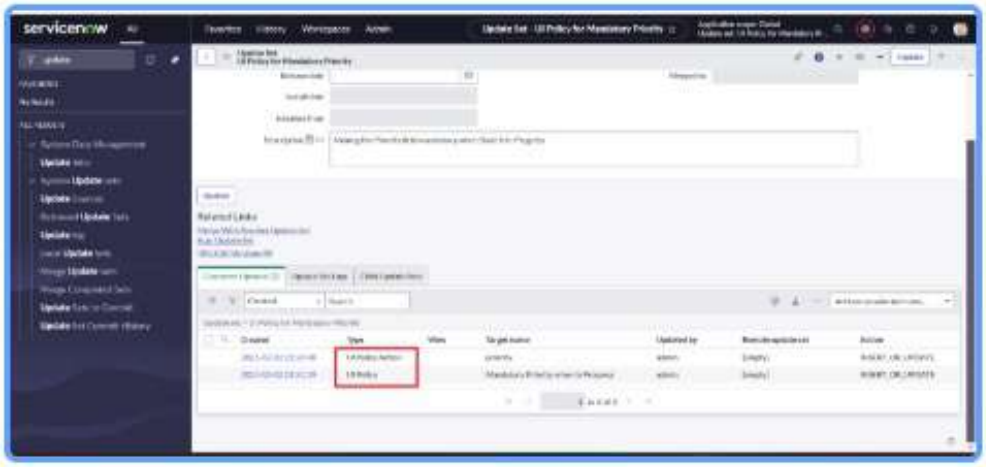
Story Duration: 39m

In Progress

Description

1. Navigate to the System Update Sets > Local Update Sets.
2. Open the 'Ui policy for mandatory priority' Update Set.

at your UI Policy and UI Policy Action are listed.



Resources

No resources available

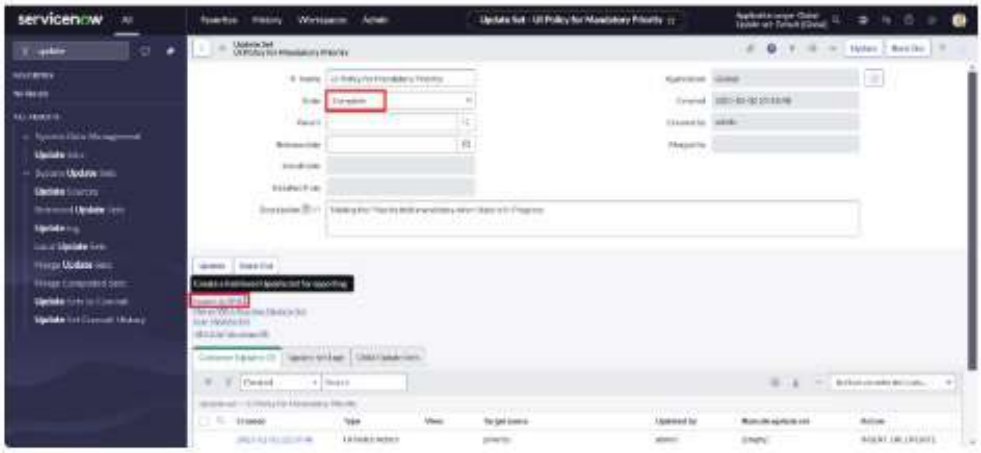
Export and Import the Update Set

Story Duration: 40m

In Progress

Description

1. Set State to Complete and Click Export to XML on the Update Set record.
2. Download the XML file.



3. Now Open Another Instance to Export Update Set.
4. Go to System Update Sets >> Retrieved Update Sets.
5. Click on the Import update set from XML and Select File and Upload

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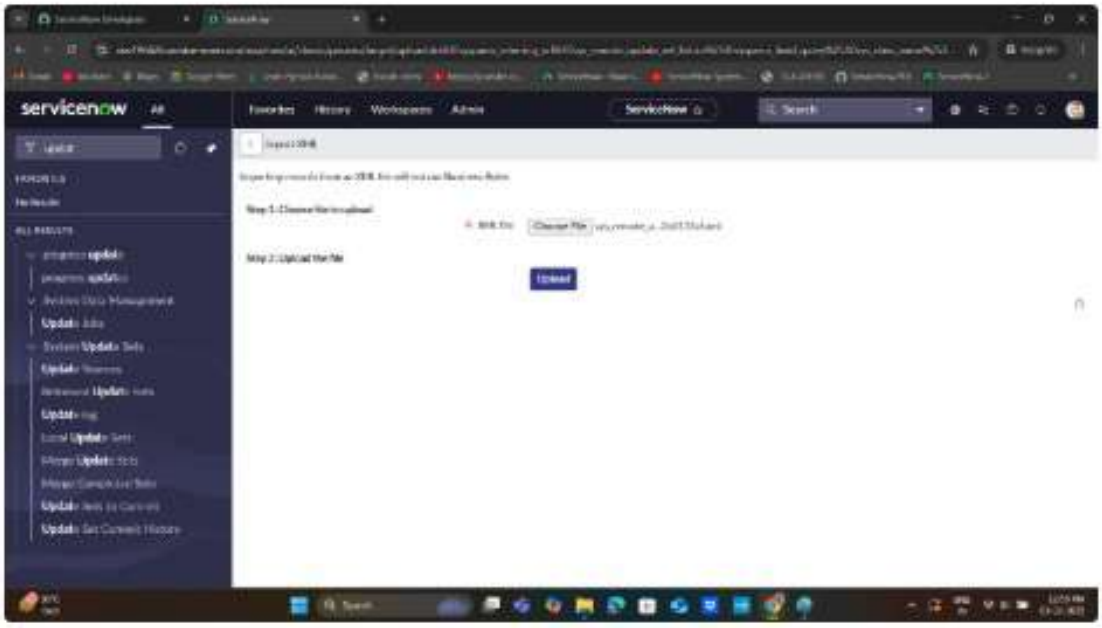
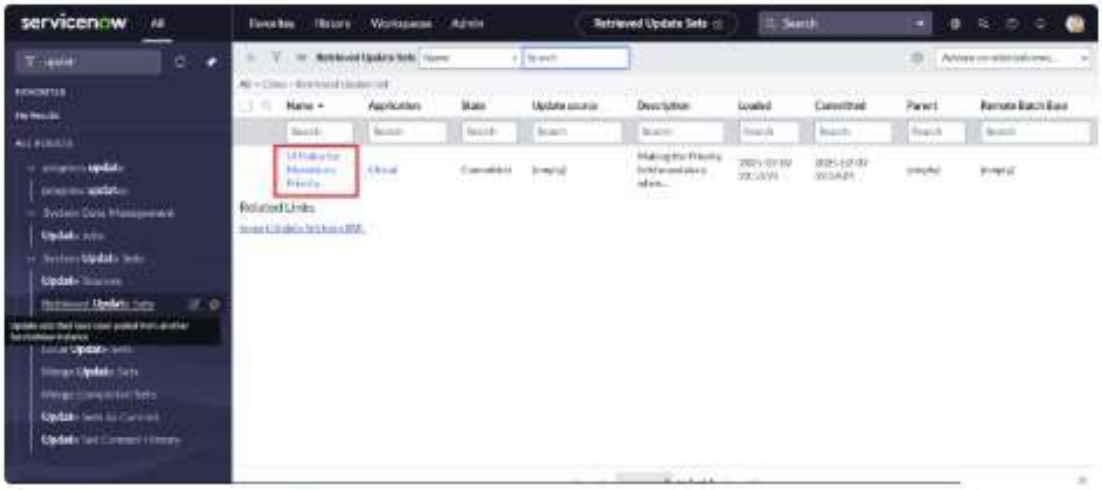
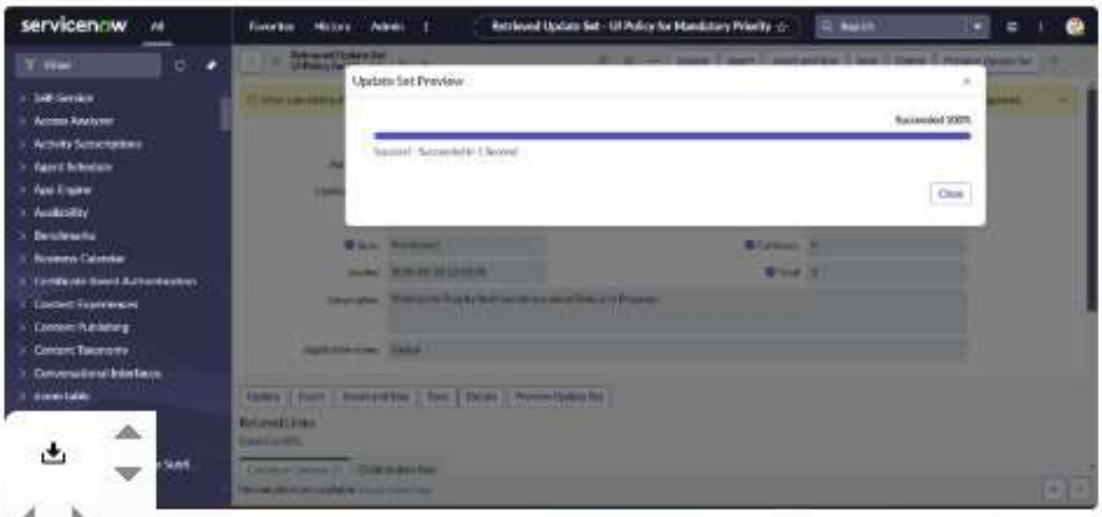


6. Open the update set that you have created in your instance here.



7. Preview the Update Set.



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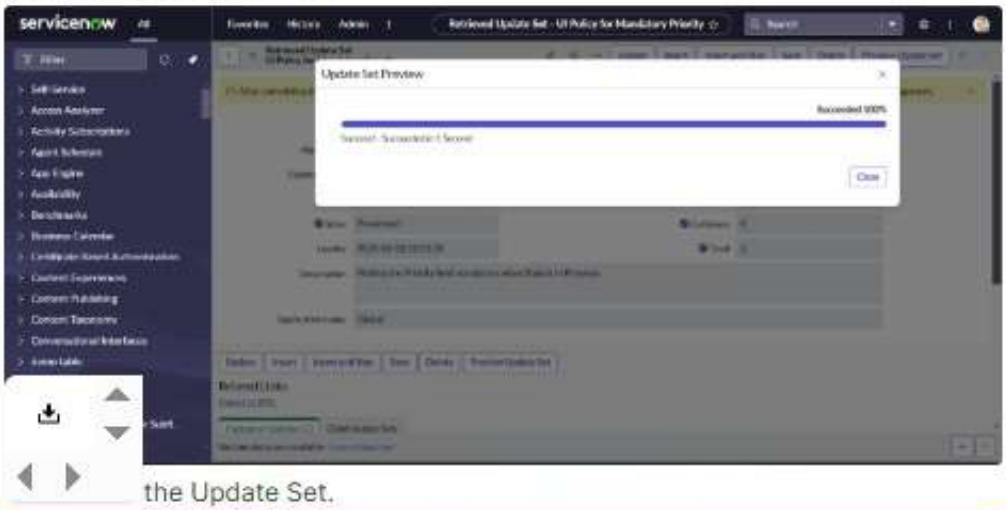

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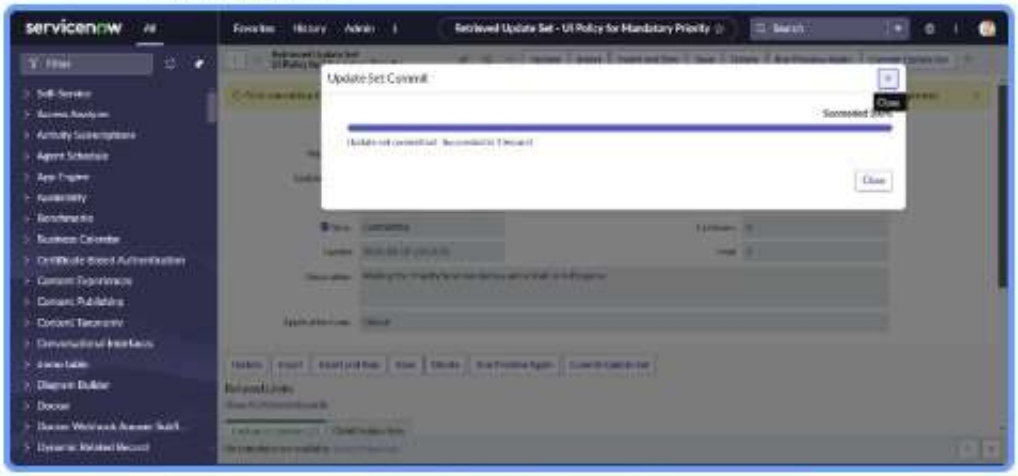


Resources

Result

Epic | Complexity: Medium | Duration: 1h 0m

Description

This phase validates the functionality of the configured UI Policy on the Incident form. An existing incident is opened or a new incident is created, and the State is changed to *In Progress*. Upon this state change, the UI Policy condition is triggered, making the **Priority** field mandatory. This test confirms that the UI Policy is working as expected, enforcing required data entry at the correct stage of the incident lifecycle and preventing users from proceeding without selecting a priority.

Resources

No resources available

Testing Incident

Story Duration: 1h 0m

In Progress

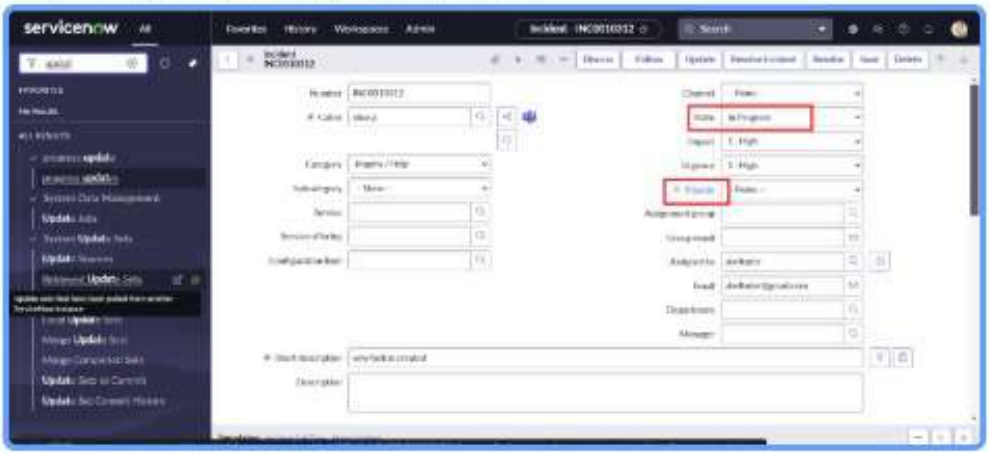
Description

1.Go to the incident module.

existing incident or create a new one.

he State is In-progress

ty field should now be mandatory



Resources

No resources available

Conclusion

Story Duration: 20m

In Progress

Description

This project effectively demonstrates the use of UI Policies to enforce business rules in a dynamic and configuration-driven manner, eliminating the need for custom scripting and preserving platform stability. By enforcing the Priority field as mandatory when an incident transitions to the *In Progress* state, the solution ensures data completeness at a critical point in the incident lifecycle, leading to better prioritization, improved operational visibility, and more consistent workflow execution. In addition, the use of Update Sets to capture, review, and migrate all configuration changes highlights best practices for controlled deployment and environment management in ServiceNow. Together, these practices showcase a scalable, upgrade-safe approach to form behaviour control and configuration governance that can be reliably applied across multiple instances.

Resources

No resources available